



PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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Correction of errors of substance may be made only on the floor of the House with the permission of the Speaker. However, correction of typographical or grammatical errors which Members suggest for the Bound Volumes which will be compiled at the end of the Meeting may be clearly marked in the Daily Report, and the copy containing the corrections submitted at the Editor's Office, Parliament House, not later than four clear days after the publication of the Daily Report.

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

THIRD MEETING, 2025

Friday, 24th October, 2025

The House met at the Chamber,

Parliament House, at 2:15 p.m.

[HON SECOND DEPUTY SPEAKER,
MR ANDREW ASIAMAH AMOAKO,
IN THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, indulge me to skip items 2,3,4 and turn to the item numbered 5, *Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND
THE OFFICIAL REPORT**

*[No correction was made to the Votes
and Proceedings of Thursday, 23rd
October, 2025]*

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, may I indulge you to turn to the item numbered 6. May I respectfully invite the Majority Leader to give us the Business of the House for the ensuing week.

No. of Question(s)

i. Minister for Health	10
ii. Minister for Roads and Highways	10
iii. Minister for Transport	3
iv. Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs	7
v. Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations	8

Total Number of Questions

3

BUSINESS OF THE HOUSE

Chairperson of the Business Committee/Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, your Committee met yesterday, Thursday, 23rd October, 2025, and arranged Business of the House for the second week which ends on Friday, 31st October, 2025.

Mr Speaker, the Committee accordingly submits its Report as follows:

Arrangement of Business

**Formal Communications by the
Speaker**

Mr Speaker, you may read any available communication to the House.

Questions

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee has scheduled the following Ministers to respond to Questions asked of them during the Week:

Mr Speaker, in all, five (5) Ministers are expected to attend upon the House to respond to thirty-two (32) Questions during the Week. The Questions are of the following types:

- i. Urgent – **3**; ii. Oral – **35**

Statements

Mr Speaker, pursuant to Order 91(2), Ministers of State may be permitted to make Statements on Government policies. You may also admit Statements by Hon Members in accordance with Order 93.

Bills, Papers and Reports

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 159, Bills may be presented to the House for First Reading. However, those of urgent nature may be taken through the various stages in a day in accordance with Order 160.

Pursuant to Order 97, Papers may be laid during the week and reports from Committees may also be presented to the House for consideration.

Motions and Resolutions

Mr Speaker, Motions may be debated and their consequential Resolutions, if any, taken during the week.

Referrals at Committees

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee is reminding all Committees with referrals to expedite consideration of the

referrals and report to the House. Once again, the Committee has attached for the attention of the House pending referrals before the respective Committees to speed up reporting. A total of two hundred and eighty-six (286) referrals has been assigned to twenty-three (23) Committees for consideration and report to the House.

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee urges all Committees to prioritise consideration of the referrals and promptly report to the House in accordance with Order 267 (4).

Conclusion

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 216 (2) and subject to Order 67, the Committee submits to the House the order in which the Business of the House shall be taken during the week.

Tuesday, 28th October, 2025

Roll Call

Oaths

National Pledge

Statements

Urgent Questions

Questions

Presentation of Papers—

(a) Annual Report of the Public
Interest and Accountability

Committee (PIAC) on the Management and Use of Petroleum Revenues for the Period January – December 2024.

Motions

Committee sittings

Wednesday, 29th October, 2025

Statements

Urgent Questions

Questions

Presentation of Papers

Motions

Committee sittings

Thursday, 30th October, 2025

Statements

Presentation of Papers

Motions

Committee sittings

Friday, 31st October, 2025

Statements

Presentation of Papers—

(a) Semi-Annual Report on the Ghana Petroleum Funds for the

period 1st January to 30th June, 2025.

(b) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tema Oil Refinery for the year 2024.

(c) Report on the Conduct of Monetary Policy, Macroeconomic Review and Banking Sector Development for the period January to June, 2025.

(d) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Minerals Income Investment Fund for the year 2024.

(e) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Cocoa Processing Company PLC for the year 2024.

(f) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Insurance Commission for the year 2024.

(g) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Export – Import Bank for the year 2024.

(h) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Infrastructure Investment Fund for the year 2024

Motions

Committee sittings.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Majority Leader. Hon Members, the Business Statement has been read to us and I would invite Members who want to contribute to it.

Yes, Hon Jerry Ahmed Shaib?

Second Deputy Minority Whip (Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib): Mr Speaker, thank you for this opportunity. We also want to thank the Leader of Government Business for bringing the Business Statement to our notice.

Mr Speaker, there are a few things I would also have to bring to his notice as Leader of Government Business.

Mr Speaker, as we speak today, the National Health Insurance Scheme (NHIS) for about two months now is not working. People have to pay before they are provided services. As we speak, the links are also not working. They are deactivated so we have virtually reverted to the cash and carry system. It is not politics. We are here to check, so, if they want to engage in politics as usual, it would not to help.

Mr Speaker, the final one is that, as we speak, any woman who is pregnant and wants to go through a Caesarean Section (CS) would have to pay between GH¢5,000.00 to GH¢9,000.00. So, we need to bring these to the notice of the Leader of Government Business so that all of these would be resolved.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Alhaji Nurideen Muhammed Mumuni?

Alhaji Nurideen Muhammed Mumuni: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker for this opportunity. I would like to use this opportunity to commend the Business Committee for the work that they have done. But it is unfortunate that recently, there are a lot of issues surrounding farmers. A lot of our farmers are suffering because they cannot find buyers for their farm produce. So, I was expecting—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: What can they not find?

Alhaji Mumuni: They cannot find buyers for their farm produce and I was expecting the Hon Majority Leader to programme the Minister for Food and Agriculture. Recently, we have seen a lot of farmers complaining throughout the country because they have so much farm produce from last season and this season. God has blessed them with bumper harvest. But unfortunately, the system is so terrible that there is no money. So, they cannot find buyers to purchase their farm produce.

So, I was expecting that the Minister for Food and Agriculture would be programmed to update the House, Ghanaians and our gallant farmers as to what strategies and plans the Ministry of Food and Agriculture is putting in place to help them get buyers for this farm produce.

2:25 p.m.

Mr Speaker, if not for the wonderful job done by the previous administration by constructing the 1 District 1 Factory

(1D1F), the farmers would have been suffering because some of these farm produce—Hon Members should go to their districts and see. There is a factory in Yendi, Zebilla, and Pusiga, and the Hon Member for Pusiga can attest to that.

Mr Speaker, if not because of the 1D1F or the 1District 1Warehouse, the farmers would have been suffering because some of these produce—*[Interruption]*. Mr Speaker, tell them that you have a warehouse in your district. There is a warehouse in Fomena, is that not it? Because if not for these warehouses, some of these farmers would have been suffering since some of these warehouses are keeping the bumper harvest of the farmers.

I am pleading with the Leader of Government Business that within the week, he could programme the Minister for Food and Agriculture to come and update Ghanaians and the entire House on what the Ministry is putting in place to get buyers for these farm produce.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Alhaji Habib Iddrisu?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the Chairman of the Committee, the Majority Leader, knows this is a Meeting for reading the Budget Statement. The Colleague of the Hon Majority Leader is distracting him. I need his attention. The first thing is that, I would like to know when we should be expecting the Budgets from the Minister for Finance. The second thing is that with the Business Statement for next week, we

should be able to find space for us to have a Closed Sitting and Committee of the Whole because there are so many issues concerning Members that we need to discuss, and for that matter, he should make provisions for us to meet. There are issues concerning Members such as the air conditioners in their offices —

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, if it is necessary, then keep quiet.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: The air conditioners in their offices are not working. There are tiling issues, among other issues that I cannot talk about on the floor of the House that affect Members and their ability to attend to Chamber work. So, if we get either a Committee of the Whole or Closed Sitting—

Mr Speaker, I do not know if the Hon Majority Leader, can programme the Hon Minister for Foreign Affairs. In his welcome address, he indicated that the United States of America (USA) Embassy had issued a statement earlier reversing our five-year multiple entry to give us a three-months single entry. It was reversed for us to be able to get five-year multiple entry if one is qualified for such visa. We need to know the reasons associated with the reversal. Is it tied to Ghana's agreement in accepting the deportees into the country? The Hon Minister for Foreign Affairs must be programmed to brief the House on the nature of the agreement, whether it was a treaty, an agreement or in whichever form that he had with the U.S.A Government. Was the agreement for us

to accept deportees because that would affect us. There is a famous Supreme Court ruling with regard to a similar case, that is the Gitmo 2 case where detainees were brought into Ghana. The Supreme Court ruled on it after it was challenged.

The Hon Minister for Foreign Affairs must come and brief the House. Did he make this agreement in order to revert to the five-year visa waiver?

We listened to His Excellency, the President of the Republic, and he gave us things he wanted to do with regard to *galamsey*. He engaged the Civil Society Organisations (CSOs). So, we can programme the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources to give us an update on *galamsey*. It is a serious issue, and it has affected a lot of people. Now, people are giving birth to deformed children. Some chemicals and other things have formed in our water. It is terrible.

The President has briefed the CSOs, but if Members of Parliament—Because we represent our constituencies and our constituents ask us questions pertaining to what is happening with regard to *galamsey*, therefore, if the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources would brief us on this issue, I think we will be all right with that.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, Alhaji Habib Iddrisu knows how to get Ministers to appear in this House and

answer Questions, and in the process, explain Government actions, inactions and policies. So, please, he has not asked a Question of the Minister for Foreign Affairs. I urge him to ask a Question. It could be an Urgent Question, and being a senior Member of this House, the Hon Minister will be invited to answer his Questions. I definitely know that it is a good thing that the American Government has reversed its visa sanctions on Ghana. We should highly commend the Minister for Foreign Affairs for the work that he has done to achieve a reversal of the visa sanctions.

As we know, many Ghanaians have family members in the U.S.A and they frequent the U.S.A. The sanctions were going to be very inconveniencing to many of those family members. In addition, there are many businesses that we engage in with the U.S.A, and the sanctions were going to cripple a lot of businesses. So, for the Minister for Foreign Affairs to have successfully, within a very short period of time, when the U.S.A announced the sanctions, got them to reverse the sanctions, that is something that we should be happy and proud of and commend the Hon Minister very highly.

I definitely know that every citizen of Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS) is entitled to sit in an aircraft and to disembark in Ghana. Every citizen of ECOWAS can fly from the U.S.A and has a right to disembark in Ghana, and then, after 90 days, can continue to their respective countries. Every ECOWAS citizen, with or without an agreement with the United States government.

I was a member of the ECOWAS Parliament, and I know the ECOWAS protocols entitle every ECOWAS citizen to decide that they want to be sent to Ghana, and when they come to Ghana, they have a right to remain in Ghana for at least 90 days. So, this is the right of every citizen. So, any agreement that we will receive a person when the person arrives in Ghana is something that is a natural consequence of the right of that ECOWAS citizen to decide that they want to disembark in Ghana from the United States. So, there is no problem at all, but I will engage the Minister for Foreign Affairs so that he will come and brief us on the situation regarding the deportations. We should not forget that it is not only ECOWAS citizens from other ECOWAS countries, but our own citizens are also being deported, and they are coming. So, we can ask the Hon Minister to come and give us a briefing.

I am told that there is a little problem about software. There are two softwares that are being used by the National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA), and there is some controversy between the two suppliers as to whose software should be used and that has crippled the process of hospitals submitting claims. But I have just been briefed that the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the NHIA has given assurance that it will be resolved very shortly between the two software providers; it has nothing to do with payments of money from the Government. The Government has given the moneys to the NHIA; they have the money. It is a software issue that they need to resolve.

2:35 p.m.

With regard to the farmers and the bumper harvest, we should be thanking God that we have bumper harvest, and thanking the Government of H. E. John Dramani Mahama, for assisting the farmers to achieve a bumper harvest. A lot of things go into bumper harvests: fertilisers, inputs, and a sound economy that enables and encourages farming. All these things go into improving productivity in the agricultural sector. So, I am happy that the Hon Member is acknowledging that within a very short time, even the agricultural sector is doing very well. I thank him very much. If I had said this on this Side of the House, he would have said that I am engaged in campaign. But he has admitted that the agricultural sector is doing very well, and that it is going to positively impact on food inflation in the coming months. What is of concern now is how we can get the produce from the farmers.

I can assure the House that I was in Cabinet when the President directed the Minister for Finance to make money available to the National Food and Buffer Stock Company so that they could buy the produce from the farmers. So, I am very sure that there will be resources available to the National Food and Buffer Stock Company to buy the produce from the farmers. And of course, I think that some of the warehouses that were constructed during the regime of President Akufo-Addo will now be useful in storing the produce from the bumper harvest that we are experiencing.

Unfortunately, I do not think any of the factories is functioning. I can say on authority that the one at Walewale is not functioning — *[Laughter]* — and that it is not processing anything. That, I can say on authority. The factories are not helpful at all in resolving this problem. So, let us leave it at that.

As for *galamsey*, I think that we will invite the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources in due course for briefing on how far we have come in terms of the fight against illegal mining and its devastation on the environment. If anybody gives birth to a child today, and that child is deformed as a result of cyanide and other heavy metals being found in their food stuff, I believe that, that pregnancy was conceived not less than nine months ago. *[Laughter]* I believe so. That pregnancy should be at least nine months old, so that the child could be born today. In that case, I think that the chemicals found in the food stuffs are attributable to the illegal mining that happened during the NPP Regime. *[Hear! Hear!]* It could not have happened today.

But we believe that as a country, we must fight the *galamsey* menace, and this House can demand accountability from the Ministers who are responsible. I also agree that during the course of next week, we should have a meeting of the Committee of the Whole to discuss all those issues.

I believe I have answered all the questions.

On the issue of the Budget Statement, I had a discussion with the Minister for Finance and he gave me a tentative date, but he is unable to announce it because

he has to receive some clearance — *[Interruption]*. Oh! that is why I am saying he is unable to announce the date. No, I cannot announce it because he has not given me the clearance. He is still going through the consultations needed to be able to announce a date. I am unable to give the specific week because that would amount to announcing the date, so let us wait for the Hon Minister to get his—Do not forget that the Hon Minister is introducing the Budget Statement on behalf of the President. It is the President's document, so he has to signal the date that the Hon Minister can present the Budget Statement.

All I can say for sure is that the Budget Statement will come and it will be a very good one.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Hon Member for Offinso North. I thought we—

Yes, let me hear from you.

Dr Fred Kyei Asamoah: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. I would like to appreciate your Business Committee for the work and the programme—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: I understand we are spending only one hour here today that is why—

Dr Asamoah: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, one issue that I believe we could have programmed the Hon Minister for Education to brief the House on is the transition of our children from the junior secondary school to the senior secondary school. There are a lot of issues that we have realised as far as the placement system is concerned. There are issues of extortion from parents according to the Parent Teacher Association (PTA) where parents are purportedly paying as much as GH¢30,000 for placement as alluded to by a Member from the Majority Side. I believe these are issues that will require an urgent action and a response from the Hon Minister for Education.

Thank you.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Member for Offinso North, why not bring the Hon Minister here to answer? I mean, it is a straightforward thing. Just file a Question and invite the Hon Minister to come and answer.

Yes, Hon Member for Suhum? And, that would be the last contribution.

Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe: Mr Speaker, I am the Deputy Ranking for the Committee on Employment, Labour Relations and Pensions, and as you are aware, unemployment is having a serious toll on the youth of our country. This Government made some pledges as to implementing some 24-Hour Economy. I will be very grateful if the Leader of the House will bring to this House their practicable policy in implementing “the one job, three shifts, three people”.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Yes, Hon Deputy Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry?

Mr Sampson Ahi: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, as a Parliament, I do not think that we should always invite Ministers to come and brief us on challenges facing the country. When Government is doing well like it is happening now, where all of us can testify that inflation has reduced to a single digit, the food inflation has gone down, prices of goods and commodities have reduced—A ton of iron rods as of December 2024 was more than GH¢12,000. It is now GH¢7,500.

2:45 p.m.

I want to find out from the Hon Majority Leader whether he is going to programme a day for us to commend the Government for what it is doing and urge the Government to do more for the country because these are the good things that we need to highlight. Both the Majority and the Minority are feeling it. We are all beneficiaries of the prudent measures by the Government, so let us dedicate a day next week to commend the Government and urge the Government to do more.

Mr Speaker, I can see you are happy with my invitation, so let us have a day next week to commend the President and Government. Thank you for the opportunity.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Peter. I am taking the last one.

Supt Rtd Peter Lanchene Toobu: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

I want to commend the Business Committee for a good job done, but I think that it is good for us to listen to the other Side. The call for various Ministers to come and brief the House is an indication of the good job they are doing and they are excited to listen to them.

Mr Speaker, for what happened in the past eight years, if people are excited to get a briefing from Ministers within 10 months, it tells us the impact the Government is making. I will encourage the Majority Leader that if it is possible, every week, he should just bring one Minister for one hour to tell us what they are doing, so that at least these people will be excited that the Government is right on track. *Aban papa aba*. Thank you so much.

Rev John Ntim Fordjour: Mr Speaker, considering the state of heightened insecurity that occurred and major events that happened while the House was on recess, that is, the conflicts that took place in Gbinyiri, which resulted in an estimated 10,000 refugees to Burkina Faso, another estimated 13,000 refugees to the Ivory Coast and 48,000 displaced residents within the Sawla-Tuna-Kalba and the Bole Bamboi districts. Also, another very worrying development in Sampa, which resulted in the killings of residents and as a matter of urgency, within next week, the Minister for the Interior and the Ag.

Minister for Defence must appear before this House to give us updates.

Live and security is more important than everything else that we demand accountability for, and it will be highly irresponsible on our part as a House if we do not demonstrate an interest in these killings that took place, and even so, concerned as to the state of our compatriots who have become refugees in other places. It is quite unheard of.

I thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think that the various Ministers are itching to have the opportunity to brief us on the work that they have been doing in the past two to three months that we have been on recess. During sessions, we get to invite them to brief us, but during the recess, they do not get to brief us, and a lot of work has been done, issues have piled up, so I can understand the call on Ministers to come and brief us. We will try to schedule as many Ministers as possible to brief us on as many issues as possible, but again, we can ask Urgent Questions so that they will be compelled to come and answer those Questions.

I also want to say in response to what Hon Ahi said about the good performance of the Government that it is perfectly possible for him to file a Motion that this House thanks the Government for doing so well in the last eight months. If he files a Motion like that and it is admitted by the Rt Hon

Speaker, we will be able to debate the Motion calling on this House to thank the Government and then of course, it will be debated. The mover of the Motion will show all the things and improvement the Government has done in the last eight months which makes him want this House to thank the Government. So, I urge him to file a Motion so we can have an opportunity to debate the performance of the Government.

I think that in a few weeks, we will have the Minister for Finance come to give us a report on the performance of the Government with all the relevant data, figures and indicators. And as usual, as a House, we will have the opportunity to debate the report of the Minister for Finance in terms of performance and then also the new policy proposals that he will present. So, we could also wait for that one.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Hon Members, let me thank all of you for your contribution. The Business Statement for the ensuing week is hereby adopted. We turn to the item numbered 7. Yesterday, I understand —

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, let me vary the order of Business, let us lay the Papers and then come back to the item numbered 7.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Hon Members, let us turn to page 2, the item numbered 8, Presentation of Papers.

PAPERS

By the Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga) —

- (i) Semi-Annual Report on the Ghana Petroleum Funds for the period 1st January to 30th June, 2025.
- (ii) Report on the Conduct of Monetary Policy, Macroeconomic Review and Banking Sector Development for the period January to June, 2025.

Referred to the Committee on Economy and Development.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Minister for Finance is not here, so I want to crave your indulgence for the Deputy Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry to lay the reports on behalf of the Minister. Those are the items numbered 8 (b)i, ii, iii, iv and v.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Leadership?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the Majority Leader's application is inadequate. If the Minister for Finance is not here, where is the Deputy Minister for Finance? Mr Speaker, it cannot be the case that they are preparing for the Budget. Because the Majority Leader cannot even tell us when we are expecting the Budget; he said he does not know, so the Majority Leader must tell us where the Minister for Finance and his Deputy are before he makes the application for Hon Ahi to lay the Paper.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I know he asked a question but he does not expect an answer, so if you can—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well, Hon Sampson Ahi, please do us the honours.

By the Deputy Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry (Mr Sampson Ahi) on behalf of the Minister for Finance—

- (i) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Infrastructure Investment Fund for the year 2024.
- (ii) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Minerals Income Investment Fund for the year 2024.
- (iii) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Insurance Commission for the year 2024.
- (iv) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Export–Import Bank for the year 2024.

Referred to the Finance Committee.

By the Deputy Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry (Mr Sampson Ahi) on behalf of the Minister for Finance—

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Cocoa Processing Company PLC for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Public Administration and State Interests.

2:55 p.m.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, again, let me crave your indulgence to vary the order of Business and take the item numbered 8(c). Again, if you will indulge us for the Deputy Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry to do that.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, may you do us the honours.

By the Deputy Minister for Trade, Industry and Agribusiness (Mr Sampson Ahi) on behalf of the Minister for Energy and Green Transition—

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tema Oil Refinery for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Energy.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, again, the Chairman of the Committee is here for us to lay item numbered 8 (d); if we may just take that.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minority Chief Whip?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Hon Leader, I think you should engage your Chairman further. My engagement with the Deputy Ranking Member on the Committee is to the effect that they only met yesterday. They have not generated any report and nothing is available. So, the Hon Leader should engage him. We will not have any difficulty laying it, provided there is a report. This is because our Standing

Orders makes it clear that to lay a report, you must distribute the report, and the Deputy Ranking Member of the Committee is saying that there is no report available. So, if otherwise, he could engage him, then we can move on with that.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Chairman, do you have the Report available?

Chairperson of the Committee on Energy (Mr Emmanuel Kwasi Bedzrah): Mr Speaker, the Report is available. The Hon Ranking Member has gone through the Report. I have even signed my portion and it is ready for distribution. Thank you.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Deputy Ranking?

Deputy Ranking Member (Mr Collins Adomako-Mensah): Mr Chairman, I have not seen any Report.
[Interruption]

Mr Bedzrah: He is not the Ranking Member.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Deputy Ranking Member?

Mr Adomako-Mensah: Mr Speaker, there is a practice on our Committee and he knows it. He is a very good Chairman. He puts the Report on our platform as Leaders. Nothing of that has happened.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think it is clear that there is some understanding that we can lay the Report.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, even the Second Deputy Speaker who is presiding is a member of the Committee. So, as I have indicated, we do not have any difficulty about laying the Report. But, if the Deputy Ranking Member says he does not have the Report, I think it is too harsh to say he is not the Ranking Member. This is because the Chairman of the Committee needs to carry them along and work with them. It is not a good practice to say that he is not the Ranking Member. So, they can go ahead and lay it but they should make sure that the Report is available and then we can move.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Yes, Chairman?

By the Chairman of the Committee on Energy (Mr Emmanuel Kwasi Bedzrah) —

Report of the Committee on Energy on the Petroleum Agreement among the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition) and Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC), GNPC Exploration and Production Limited Company (Explorco) and Tristar Upstream Oil and Gas Limited (Tristar) for the exploration, development and production operations in the Ghana Western Basin Block 1 (GH_WB_01).

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we may now go back to Statements.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, before we take the Statement, let us acknowledge our students at the Public Gallery. The first school is Mercy Islamic Junior High School (JHS). They are being led by Benjamin Bonsrah who is a teacher and National Commission for Civic Education (NCCE) patron. The school is located in the Adentan Constituency. I hope the Hon Member of Parliament is here and will take care of you.

[Pupils of Mercy Islamic J.H.S were acknowledged]

The second school is Etsibeedu D/A Basic School. They are being led by Madam Grace Sarkodie, who is the assistant head teacher, and the school is located in the Ekumfi Constituency. Do we have the Hon Member of Parliament here?

All right.

You are welcome. I hope you are monitoring what is going on, and that should edge you on to study hard so that tomorrow, you will come and take over from us. You are once again welcome.

[Pupils of Etsibeedu D/A Basic School were acknowledged]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we would take a Statement from the Chairperson of the Committee on Youth and Sports, Dr Ernest Henry Norgbey who is congratulating the Black Stars. Let us hear you.

STATEMENTS

Congratulatory Message by the Hon Chairman for the Youth and Sports Committee of Parliament

Dr Ernest Henry Norgbey (NDC — Ashaiman): Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity to, on behalf of the Parliamentary Committee on Youth and Sports, congratulate the Black Stars for qualifying for the 2026 FIFA World Cup tournament scheduled for June, 2026, in the United States of America, Canada and Mexico.

Mr Speaker, as you are respectfully aware, Ghana secured its spot for this important global tournament on Sunday, 12th October, 2025, after the Black Stars secured a 1-0 victory over Comoros to top Group I with 25 points. It has been an intensive two-year qualifying journey, and it is indeed a great feat that the Black Stars, our pride and beacon of hope, has joined eight (8) other African countries to represent our beloved continent in North America.

Our players have indeed displayed resilience, discipline, commitment and dedication throughout the qualifying stages, and I commend them for playing with focus and passion to once again place Ghana on the world stage. Special mention and commendation go to the coach and technical bench of the team for their instrumentality and guidance in making this victory possible.

Mr Speaker, as we celebrate this momentous achievement, I encourage the Black Stars to continue to put in their

best in order to showcase Ghanaian football skills and talents on the international stage. They should not lose sight of the ultimate goal for which they strived to outperform other African football teams to clinch a slot at the qualifying stages. Teamwork is the only way to secure the 2026 FIFA World Cup and make history as the first country on the continent of Africa to win the tournament.

I am optimistic that His Excellency the President, the Ministry of Sports and Recreation, the Ghana Football Association and its relevant Agencies would provide the needed resources to facilitate the participation of our players.

The Parliamentary Select Committee on Youth and Sports is also poised to offer the necessary support to ensure that the Black Stars advance beyond the group stages and aim for gold.

The bigger work lies ahead of us. I call on the various supporters' unions and all Ghanaians to rally behind the Black Stars in the coming months. Ghana Black Stars, we are proud of you; keep shining, keep striving and continue to inspire and unify Ghanaians across the world with splendid performances.

I thank you once again, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to make this congratulatory Statement, and also to state that as the Chairman of the Committee, any Member of Parliament who does not congratulate the Black Stars will not go to the World Cup.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

3:05 p.m.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Members, we have to manage the numbers. So, let me hear from you.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, with the leave of my Leader, let me also, in the spirit of commemoration make a brief Statement commending— Mr Speaker, we will take one or two on each Side, briefly, limited to, say, two minutes. If that meets your—Yes. But in terms of determining the number of contributors on either Side, I am praying that you limit it to two on each Side with two minutes each.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Let me see the interest. Two contributions from each Side, but I will be guided by the interest of the House.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may I seek your leave to, in five minutes, make a short Statement commemorating Mawuli School for their 75th anniversary, which falls tomorrow. Mr Speaker, may I urge the Table Office to adopt the entire Statement as presented.

Commemorative Statement on the 75th Anniversary of Mawuli School

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor (NDC — South Dayi): Mr Speaker, Mawuli School, located in Ho, was established in the year 1950. It was one of the first second cycle schools in the Volta Region. The school played a significant role in shaping the educational landscape in the Region.

Mr Speaker, Mawuli school was established through a collaboration between the Evangelical Presbyterian Church, and the American Evangelical and Reformed Church on one side, and the Colonial Government of Gold Coast on the other. The school was built on the pillars of providing holistic education rooted in discipline, faith, and academic excellence. The Mawuli School has its motto as: Head, Heart, Hand.

Mr Speaker, I stand here as a former product of Mawuli School. The motto, “Head”, stands for excellence in everything we do, “Heart”, admonishes giving back to society, while “Hand” represents the need to work for self-sufficiency.

Mawuli School was unique even from its very inception. That uniqueness of Mawuli School was rightly captured in an article by Elizabeth Ohene published in *Graphic Online* on Wednesday, October 22, 2025 under the heading “Mawuli - The standout school”. She stated,

"Right from the beginning, the emphasis was not just on science subjects but on practical living". "...we were encouraged to see the hoe and cutlass as items to be used in daily life. It did not matter if one was going to be a doctor, an engineer or a teacher, a Mawuli student had to be a gardener and able to change a plug as well."

Mr Speaker, Mawuli was a different type of school. Mawuli School, is one of Ghana's most accomplished second cycle institutions. Mawuli School has produced some of Ghana's finest patriotic and impactful leaders in governance, academia, business, medicine, the arts, among others.

Old Mawuli Students Union (OMSU) is the alumni group which has remained tied to the school for the impact the school has made on them. Mr Speaker, the first Headmaster of Mawuli School was Rev Prof Dr Walter P. Trost, who served the school between the year 1950 and 1960. Since its establishment, the school has had 15 headmasters. The current headmaster is Mr Jonathan G. Adomah, who took office in the year 2019.

Mr Speaker, Mawuli School has also produced notable impact-makers including Hon Kofi Attoh, special advisor to your good self; Hon Sallas Mensah, former MP for Upper West Akim and a former Chairman of the Public Accounts Committee of Parliament; Justice Sulley Gbadegbe, a former Supreme Court Justice; Hon Della Sowah, former MP for Kpando; Hon George Loh, former MP for North Dayi; Akofa Edjeani Asiedu, a famous actress; Oscar Korbla Mawuli Awuku, a Ghanaian body artist, painter, and sculptor; the famous late Efo Kojo Mawugbe, a Ghanaian award-winning playwright and former director of the National Theatre of Ghana; Madam Elizabeth Ohene, a renowned Ghanaian journalist, politician and a former Minister of State for Tertiary Education.

Mr Speaker, others include the venerable Akua Sena Dansua, an experienced Ghanaian media and communications consultant, politician and governance and leadership practitioner, a former Member of this House, the late Hon Bernice Adiku Heloo who was also a former Member of this House, and Justice Ernest Gaewu, a Ghanaian lawyer who served on the Supreme Court of Ghana. Mention can also be made of Mr Ben Dotse Marlor, currently Ghana's Deputy Head of Missions for the United States of America. In the area of sports, Mr Speaker, Mawuli School produced the likes of Father Emmanuel Adjogu of Black Starlets and Black Meteors fame.

Mr Speaker, I stand here myself as a past student of the Mawuli School. With me in this Chamber are four other Members of Parliament: Hon Kwame Govers Agbodza, Minister for Roads and Highways and MP for Adaklu; Hon Charles Agbeve, MP for Agotime-Ziope, Hon Edem Agbana, MP for Ketu North and Hon Sebastian Deh, MP for Kpando who are all proud products of Mawuli School.

Mr Speaker, Mawuli School is heavily supported by its Alumni who are actively involved in the school's development. The 2000 Year Group recently renovated the historic "White Block" building. The White Block building of Mawuli School is a symbol of heritage and transition and was among the school's foundational structures. Being an architectural landmark steeped in memory and tradition, it served as one of the first classroom complexes and was

instrumental in the nurturing of thousands of "Mawulians" over generations. The school has undergone several significant infrastructural developments, including projects like the Assembly Hall and a resource centre for the blind.

Mr Speaker, this year marks the school's 75th anniversary. The anniversary celebration was marked with a week-long festivity, highlighting a celebration that brought together former students, former teachers, the Mawuli Community, friends and admirers from both far and near.

Mr Speaker, as the school celebrates its 75th anniversary, I want to thank all who have significantly impacted the school by making constant contributions to keep the school going exceptionally. I want to encourage all former students to join the Alumni which has become the vehicle for transformation at our alma mater.

I thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

[Published by order of Mr Speaker]

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mawuli School of which I am a proud former student, is celebrating its 75th anniversary, which falls tomorrow. It is the pride of the Volta region which produced some outstanding lawyers, judges, politicians, some having risen to become Leaders in this House. Mr Speaker, I want to wish them well and urge the school to continue to produce morally upright students to serve this nation in very sensitive places

like the Judiciary, the Legislature, the Executive, and other public institutions in this country.

Mr Speaker, I want to urge the House to join us tomorrow in Ho to honour the school in celebrating its 75th anniversary.

I thank you for the opportunity.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Yes?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the earlier application made by the Majority Chief Whip with regard to the number of people who will contribute to the Statement made by the Chairman of the Committee on Youth and Sports, Hon Asafo-Adjei Ayeh had also presented a Statement on the same subject matter. So, because the Chairman delivered the Statement, we urge him to contribute and then his Statement will also be captured, but he will be contributing.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: So, on our Side, Mr Speaker, we agree that it should be two each and Leadership because we have other Business. Hon Ayeh will start.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Ayeh, you will just contribute, but your Statement will be taken as having been read.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Admission of contribution is important. Not just two

on each Side but essentially two minutes because of the exigencies of—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. So, Hon Ayeh, as your Leader said, you will not read the Statement, you will just contribute, but I would direct that your Statement will be taken on board as if you have read it in full.

Ghana's Qualification for the 2026 FIFA World Cup

Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh (NPP — Bosome Freho) and Mr Eric Edem Agbana (NDC — Ketu North): With profound pride and gratitude, we rise to congratulate our beloved senior National Team, the Black Stars of Ghana, on their historic qualification for the 2026 FIFA World Cup, to be hosted across the United States of America (USA), Canada, and Mexico. This remarkable achievement is not only a triumph of skill and endurance but a powerful reminder of the strength and unity that define us as a people. Once again, the Black Stars have carried the hopes of millions, lifted the spirit of our nation, and reaffirmed Ghana's place among the giants of world football.

Mr Speaker, this qualification marks Ghana's fifth appearance at the FIFA World Cup since our historic debut in Germany 2006, when we became the only African debutant to advance to the Round of 16. Our unforgettable quarterfinal run in South Africa 2010 remains one of Africa's proudest moments on the global stage, and this latest success rekindles that same national optimism and continental pride.

Football in Ghana is more than a game; it is a national language that unites our people beyond ethnicity, faith, and politics. From the bustling streets of Accra to the vibrant communities we represent, in Bosome Freho, Ketu North, and beyond, Ghanaians celebrated this qualification as one family under one flag.

Mr Speaker, we commend the players, technical team, and management staff for their discipline, resilience, and teamwork, the Ghana Football Association for its coordination, and the millions of fans at home and abroad whose prayers, belief, and passion inspired this triumph. We also pay tribute to the unsung heroes across our communities, the local coaches, grassroots academies, and football-loving families, whose daily sacrifices and quiet dedication continue to nurture the dreams that light up our national colours.

This moment calls for a renewed spirit of national unity, a reminder that in our shared victories, there are no political colours, only the red, gold, and green of Ghana. In moments like these, the spirit of bipartisanship must rise above division. Our collective pride in this victory should translate into collective responsibility to support our national team.

As Presidents John Dramani Mahama and Nana Addo Dankwa Akufo-Addo have both reminded us, teamwork, sacrifice, and dedication are the cornerstones of national success. The Black Stars embody these same values,

showing that unity, not division, powers victory. The Black Stars' journey has proven that national pride is earned through preparation, sacrifice, and unity of purpose. It is now our shared duty, as policymakers, administrators, and citizens, to ensure that this moment translates into lasting progress for Ghanaian sports and youth empowerment.

Ghana's qualification also carries the hopes of Africa. Once again, our nation stands ready to raise the continental banner high and demonstrate that African excellence knows no limits when discipline and belief guide the way. Across our constituencies and throughout Ghana, our young people draw inspiration from the Black Stars, proof that with opportunity, guidance, and focus, even humble beginnings can shine on the world's biggest stage.

Mr Speaker, we therefore urge all stakeholders, government, corporate bodies, and civil society, to rally around the Black Stars with renewed commitment. Let us ensure that this World Cup journey reflects not only our passion for football but also our enduring faith in Ghana's promise. May the Black Stars remind us that nations, like teams, rise when every citizen plays their part. When they shine, Ghana shines, and when Ghana shines, Africa stands taller.

God bless the Black Stars. God bless our homeland Ghana.

[Published by order of Mr Speaker]

Mr Ayeh: Mr Speaker, I only want to submit that it is a joint Statement between myself and the Member of Parliament for Ketu North, Mr Eric Edem Agbana, congratulating the Black Stars. I only want to put that on record.

Mr Speaker, I want to thank you and also use this platform to congratulate our Black Stars. From our debut in 2006 in Germany, the Black Stars gave a splendid performance, where Ghana became the only team in Africa that had to progress to the round of 16. Fast forward, in 2010 at South Africa, where again, we put up a very splendid performance that saw the admiration of all the people in the world.

Mr Speaker, we have qualified once again to another World Cup, which will be played in Mexico, Canada, and United States of America (USA). For the first time after a long time, I saw the teeming number of Ghanaians beaming with happiness, seeing the Black Stars qualify for yet another World Cup. It brings a lot of inspiration, with a whole lot of expectations. Some expect to cheer the Black Stars on, others expect to see the Black Stars progress, while others expect to see the Black Stars making the African continent and the Black race proud again like we used to do, or like we are known for.

Mr Speaker, Government and successive governments, have made some contributions towards ensuring that our Black Stars become the hope of Africa. Football, again, cuts across both races. It has no boundary and knows no political colouration.

In rounding up, I would say that this is another opportunity for us to show the “Ghanaian-ness” in us and prove to the African race that, in fact, we are the star and the hope of the African continent. Let us admonish that this whole arrangement and preparation towards the Black Stars’ performance in the World Cup will be non-partisan and will open doors for every other person who wants to participate.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Hon Members, two minutes is two minutes, because from here we are moving to our Colleague’s house, and they are expecting us within the time that we gave them. So, let me give it to the Hon Minister for Government Communication.

Mr Felix Kwakye Ofori (NDC — Abura-Asebu-Kwamankese): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity. I have retained abiding faith in the Black Stars, even in the periods where they underperformed, and I am gratified that they have justified that support with this splendid qualification display.

In the aftermath of the qualification, a number of issues have come to the fore, which I believe merits our attention. There have been calls for the dismissal of the coach who guided us on this qualification path. I believe that these calls are a bit unfortunate and they are misplaced, because the man who has guided us to this qualification in stellar fashion is best placed to prepare the team

for the competition itself. Because the way national teams work these days, there is hardly any time for the team to camp for an extensive period in order to hone their tactics and prepare for the competition itself. So, it would be a tragic mistake to dismiss the coach and hire a new person who will have very little time to prepare the team. The competition is in about seven months, but in between that period, the team will not be camping for more than three or four occasions, and that time is simply too short for any experimentation.

The second issue is that there has been a flurry of requests by some Ghanaian players born overseas or who have played overseas to be considered for selection. Many people have expressed outrage at this development and demanded that only players who were available for the qualification series should be considered. Mr Speaker, I call for some caution in the way that we approach this matter. It is true that there were some players who rebuffed our entreaties in the past, because perhaps they were hedging to see if nations who have a higher profile in international football would give them a call. But there are areas in the team that require some improvements, and therefore I will call for sober reflections on this matter. This is so that in the areas where we are weak, if there are players who have shown greater ability than the current players we have, we consider them, based, of course, on merit, because there is something to be gained from doing so. Sometimes, if we are not careful and we act out of emotion, we may make mistakes that will come back to haunt us.

So, on that note, I commend the team, coach and Minister for Sports and Recreation highly for supervising this impressive qualification.

3.15 p.m.

Mr Eric Edem Agbana (NDC — Ketu North): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity to contribute to the two Statements. I am also proud to mention that I am a proud alumnus of the Mawuli Senior High School in Ho; that is the school that is celebrating its 75th Anniversary tomorrow. Over the years, Mawuli Senior High School has become an example of how alumni associations can contribute to building the educational sector in our country. I want to join the Majority Chief Whip in wishing all *Mawulians* across the globe and every well-wisher of Mawuli Senior High School the very best as we celebrate our anniversary tomorrow.

Mr Speaker, back to football. As you are aware, I am a fanatic of football. I am very proud of the Black Stars and our recent achievement of qualifying to the 2026 World Cup. The Black Stars have shown over and over again that when the right investments are made in sports, we will get the results. The fact that Mr Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh and I partnered to read a Statement shows that when it comes to football and the Black Stars, there is no partisanship, and all of us, as Ghanaians, must rally behind the team as we move to the 2026 World Cup, and produce the best of results for this country.

In conclusion, I disagree with my Brother, Mr Felix Kwakye Ofori, on the selection of players. I believe that to qualify to be selected for the Black Stars, a player must come with a certain level of commitment. Every player who rejected a call-up during the qualification does not deserve a place in the team as we move to the World Cup. We must teach every Ghanaian the value of patriotism and commitment. We must let the young people of this country appreciate that, whether in tough times or not, we must all be prepared to sacrifice and die for this country. Those who sacrificed and qualified should be the ones selected for the World Cup.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Let me give the opportunity to Leadership.

First Deputy Minority Whip (Alhaji Habib Iddrisu): Mr Speaker, thank you. Let me also join my Colleagues to congratulate the Black Stars, the technical team, Ghana Football Association (GFA), and the Ministry of Sports and Recreation. We are very proud of our boys. We are proud of the Black Stars because we are going to the World Cup Tournament again. Mr Speaker, we do not have enough time to talk, but I would want to draw the attention of the Majority Chief Whip that the 2026 World Cup in either Canada, the United States of America (USA) or Mexico must not be a repetition of what happened in Brazil, 2014. We must, as much as possible, make sure that what happened in Brazil does not happen again.

Mr Speaker, I thank you. When we get more opportunity, we will discuss further. There should not be any scandal in this 2026 World Cup.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, let me join Colleagues in congratulating the Black Stars for qualifying to participate in the soccer jamboree in the USA, Canada and Mexico. I believe that Ghanaians have been yearning for this opportunity and it has come our way. I have always indicated that I have absolute confidence in the Black Stars because at one point, I was the Minister for Youth and Sports and I worked with them in Equatorial Guinea. I know that when given the needed support, they can rise up to the occasion. So, what we need to give them is all the support, financially, and even more so, technical support.

I am not passing judgement on anyone, but what makes an excellent team is young players with potential—I believe they have that; good coaching, good technical support, and of course, adequate resources for them to afford the good coaching, good technical support, and the needed motivation on a match-by-match basis. These are the key things. I saw how these key factors took the Black Stars from almost being eliminated at the first round in Equatorial Guinea up to the finals where they faced Ivory Coast. They held their own against major stars that were playing on the side of Ivory Coast and ended in a penalty shoot and we lost during penalty.

So, I know that the boys can do very well when supported and when given the right motivation. Ghanaians must be willing to support them. I also know that a lot of Ghanaians are looking forward to go and support them, so we must have a strategy for ensuring that as many Ghanaians who can afford as possible are able to access the countries that are hosting the tournament to support our players. Given that there are three different countries and those countries are far apart from one another—Because if you look at the distance from Canada to Mexico, and they are playing a match in Canada and their next match is in Mexico, how to ferry supporters to Mexico from Canada is going to be a major challenge. So, these logistical issues must be discussed and also, we must have a very strong engagement with the government of the USA and Canada so that our citizens will be able to access those countries to support our players.

On that note, let me thank the Black Stars and commend the GFA for a yeoman's job in helping us to qualify. I also think that our women, the Black Queens, have been doing well and on this occasion, we should also commend them for achievements that they have chalked and the efforts that they have put in.

Mr Speaker, thank you. I am thankful to the maker of the Statement.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, before I come back to Leadership for direction, let me bring you back to the item numbered 8(a) (ii), Presentation of Papers. I think I made the

referral to the Committee on Finance. It is supposed to go to the Committee on Economy and Development for consideration and report. So, the referral has been changed to Committee on Economy and Development.

Lastly, we also have another school, Graceland ChildCare School. They are being led by Sedor Salome, who is the headteacher. The school is located in the Awutu-Senya West Constituency.

[Pupils of Graceland Childcare School were acknowledged]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: On that note, let me come back to Leadership for direction.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, yesterday we agreed as a House that we would be going to the residence of the former president to commiserate with the family, so we would take an early adjournment. So, Mr Speaker, I move that you adjourn this House until Tuesday at 2:00 p.m. to enable us to embark on this assignment.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I second the Motion for adjournment.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was accordingly adjourned 3:24 p.m. till Tuesday, 28th October, 2025 at 2 o'clock in the afternoon.

